

renting property, there are many hurdles they must jump if they try to do this without an approving male guardian.

Until quite recently, buying property and investing in shares were not on the list of things women could do to generate wealth. They had to rely on their fathers, husbands and brothers to take care of their financial wellbeing. Inheritances were still largely given to the male child, and in some corners of the world these practices are still occurring.

We have missed out on thousands of years of financial discourse. Fathers passed this information down to their sons, but why tell your daughter the importance of investing or saving when she can't even open up a bank account alone?

Still, this doesn't mean women weren't smart with money. In many cultures, including the South Asian culture I grew up with, grandmothers and mothers would collect gold jewellery as a hedge against inflation — a concept investors now incorporate into their stock market investing strategies with gold. They would then pass it down to their daughters when they left their village for marriage. No bank account? No problem. Gold is a valued commodity, and one that can easily be liquidated for cash in case of an emergency.

You see, women always knew the value of money, always knew the importance of investing and always passed down their version of financial literacy to their children. Replace 'gold' with any heirloom, whether it be silver, copper, jewellery or cutlery, and you'll quickly realise this was happening in many cultures; women invested in the commodities available to them. Our grandmothers and great grandmothers knew the importance of being financially independent. We've always been good with investing, despite living in systems that were trying to keep us out. But now is the time for us to learn about the formal financial structures that used to be unavailable to us.

Money media not representing us

Mainstream media have done a great job at portraying the credit-card loving, shopaholic woman. Millennials and Gen Z in particular grew up watching these classics: Alicia Silverstone in *Clueless* portrayed a character